

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 6 OF SIX

The Joint Commission for Bringing a Friend

*Native cooperative games, shared puzzles and stories for an optional
companion*

Forty real games. One wildly unnecessary department.

A comic companion, written by ChatGPT under Nolan's creative direction.

Reader edition 1.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

Before the stamp hits the page

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; Aiden's ministry and rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. Promising, conditional and detour are editorial labels, not measurements of anyone's ability. Read the catch on the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 6. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department's forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index at the back always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P201	P202	P203	P204	P205	P206	P207	P208
2. Ready for conversation	P209	P210	P211	P212	P213	P214	P215	P216
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P217	P218	P219	P220	P221	P222	P223	P224
4. Here for the atmosphere	P225	P226	P227	P228	P229	P230	P231	P232
5. Open to a wildcard	P233	P234	P235	P236	P237	P238	P239	P240

Local position = $8 \times (\text{row} - 1) + \text{emblem}$. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = $40 \times (\text{department} - 1) + \text{local position}$.

Two Controllers, One Astonishingly Bad Contract

I bought a second controller and announced that loneliness had been defeated. Tank asked where the batteries were. I told him he was focusing on implementation instead of vision. He put the controller down. My victory lasted eleven seconds.

The Joint Commission for Bringing a Friend met at the same table that had survived the other five volumes. Survived was the right word. Its legs had begun making small noises of legal significance. The game binder lay across the middle like a bridge that had been designed by a man who hated rivers. Beside it sat the gold stamp, the tiny red stapler, and a plate of sandwiches Rosa had expressly excluded from all jurisdiction.

I had prepared seats for Player One and Player Two. Player One's seat reclined. Player Two's was a folding chair with a sticker that said AUXILIARY.

Shawna peeled off the sticker.

"Everybody gets a comfortable chair."

"The design expresses roles."

"So does a throne. We aren't putting one in the living room."

Tank looked toward the hallway. I looked somewhere else. The delivery men would be informed.

The reader had asked, at various points, whether a game could be enjoyed together. I had heard an opportunity to establish a commission. Those were not the same request. Mercedes made me write the ordinary question on the first page: what would each person actually do?

That exposed a surprising number of differences. In some games, two people each controlled a character. In some, one character had more abilities than the other. In others, players needed separate devices and had to describe information neither could see in full. Some games offered distinct cooperative levels rather than a shared version of the main story. And some had no native cooperative mode at all; two people could still enjoy discussing a puzzle while one operated the controls.

I had labelled all of these TWO FRIENDS, EXCELLENT. Shawna returned the page with the kind of silence that means a document has disappointed a woman personally.

"We need the distinction," she said.

"We have a distinction. Excellent is in italics."

Rosa took the marker from me.

We made three plain signs. Two people controlling the game. Two people sharing ideas around one player's game. A game for somebody who specifically wanted its action demands. The last sign was necessary because friendly art could conceal a lot of running, jumping, aiming, holding, and falling off things. A knitted character could demand excellent timing while looking as if it had personally forgiven you.

Tank recovered the batteries from the drawer marked HISTORICAL RECORDS. The records were mostly spare cables and a receipt for the sign that said I UNDERSTAND. He installed them in the second controller. I watched him perform the practical miracle my announcement had skipped.

"Now," he said, "who's doing what?"

That became our opening question for every shared game. A helpful friend could handle a menu or read a clue, if invited. A helpful friend could also become a second weather system, shouting instructions while pushing the pace. We agreed to describe before commanding, ask before taking over, and leave space for the person holding the controls to make the interesting decision.

Mercedes tested the arrangement by handing me a sandwich.

“Eat this cooperatively.”

I held one side. Tank held the other. We looked at each other for a while.

“This is stupid,” he said.

“Some activities have a natural lead.”

Rosa cut the sandwich in half. It was the first redesign of the day to improve everybody's experience without a presentation.

The native-co-op label would describe a feature, not a social obligation. Nobody owed us a second player. Nobody needed permission to enjoy a game alone. Where cooperative support depended on an edition, a platform, an update, or a particular mode, we would say so. The original Secret of Mana and its later remake were not one interchangeable object merely because their names matched. My filing cabinet had tried that trick with three different insurance policies. It had not survived contact with Shawna.

We also needed to distinguish a first trial from a promise about the whole game. A pleasant opening could introduce later timers, fights, menus, or demanding movement. Our invitation was to test one useful thing: a conversation between players, a room, a small build, a puzzle, a handoff. We were not scheduling anybody's endurance.

I stamped the revised charter. This time the ink worked. Unfortunately I had placed the charter on the sandwich plate.

“You certified the bread,” Tank said.

I turned the slice over. JOINT COMMISSION shone blue across the crust.

Mercedes leaned back in her comfortable chair. “At least that one actually supports two people.”

We ate the unstamped halves and opened the binder. The second controller remained available. It did not acquire authority over anybody by being present.

P201 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Secret of Mana

The Sword Requires Fewer Speeches and More Attention

Edition considered: 1993 SNES original / Collection of Mana on Switch; not 2018 remake

I lifted a cardboard sword and announced that the three of us would restore balance to the world. Tank asked whether balance included moving the binder away from the edge of the table. I said the quest had many layers.

Secret of Mana gave us forests, companions and monsters that did not wait for my speeches. I attempted to negotiate with the first creature by explaining our cooperative values. It appeared unmoved by the committee's mission statement.

Shawna reached for the ring menu. For a moment, the action stopped and we could think. I immediately proposed a subcommittee on swords. She closed the menu before I found a chairperson.

Rosa clarified that playing together meant each person actually wanted to fight, explore and manage the party. It did not mean Tank performed every difficult action while I called it leadership. We set down the cardboard sword and agreed to try one familiar area, with both voices carrying more weight than my heroic introduction.

The actual attraction

The original 1993 adventure offers a colourful party journey with native cooperative fighting once companions join. Its overhead view removes free-camera steering, while towns, equipment, magic and connected areas give the journey continuity.

The catch worth knowing

Combat runs in real time. Original manual instructions include held dashing and charged attacks, plus Y opening the paused ring menu. Original SNES two-player play needs two controllers; a third needs a multiplayer adapter. Collection of Mana supports up to three. The 2018 remake is excluded.

An opening invitation

Enjoy the solo opening together or use an existing shared save after an ally joins. Try moving, opening the ring and one familiar encounter. The second player should choose their own role rather than automatically receiving every difficult job.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional retro expedition for two willing adventurers; my cardboard sword qualifies only as evidence that packaging can develop delusions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo Collection of Mana page confirms original Secret of Mana supports 1-3 players. Original manual text inspected through archival transcription establishes ring pause, held actions and SNES controller/adapter rules. Ally-gated joining follows party availability. No 2018 PC remake metadata is used.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/en-ca/store/products/collection-of-mana-switch/>

Source 2: https://www.world-of-nintendo.com/manuals/super_nes/secret_of_mana.shtml

P202 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Spiritfarer: Farewell Edition

The Ferry's Emotional Baggage Exceeds My Luggage Allowance

Edition considered: PC Farewell Edition

I designed a passenger ferry with a ballroom, a portrait gallery and an extremely small place for passengers. Rosa asked where anyone would sleep. I pointed to a future expansion marked COMFORT, PENDING PRESTIGE.

Spiritfarer had a better order of priorities. People arrived carrying needs, histories and the knowledge that a journey could end. My proposed Captain's Welcome was seven pages long. Tank used page four to level the model boat.

Daffodil the cat had my immediate respect: excellent presence, no committee membership required. I announced that I would take the cat role and supervise from an attractive ledge. Shawna suggested actually testing what the two roles could do before allocating our entire friendship.

We cooked one imaginary meal and removed the ballroom from the plan. Mercedes kept the window seat. The boat was smaller, more useful and considerably less impressed with me. I found that I could bear this, particularly when somebody passed me the bread.

The actual attraction

Build and travel on a ferry, care for spirits, gather materials and eventually say goodbye. The Farewell Edition includes the expanded character stories. Native local cooperation pairs Stella with Daffodil, giving two people a shared place to inhabit.

The catch worth knowing

Movement includes jumping and gliding; chores, recipes and resources accumulate. The cat's role differs from Stella's. A previously inspected secondary walkthrough identifies Elena's later timed Gold Dragon challenge, so the gentle presentation is not a no-rush guarantee. Bereavement is the central theme.

An opening invitation

Meet a passenger, walk around the boat and try one chore in each role. Check whether both people enjoy what their character can do. Leave the larger building plan alone until the small shared activity feels worthwhile.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

For company that wants to care for a floating household; the committee has denied my application to become Admiral of the Pantry.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam publisher description confirms Farewell Edition activities and local Daffodil cooperation. Prior inspected GuideStrats walkthrough supplies the secondary-source warning about Elena and the timed Gold Dragon; not represented as a developer access statement.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/972660/>

Source 2: <https://guidestrats.com/spiritfarer-elena-guide/>

P203 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: unknown / native co-op: yes

Pode

A Rock Has Been Appointed My Publicist

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

I volunteered to play the fallen star, for reasons I considered obvious. Tank volunteered to be the rock, for reasons he said were becoming increasingly obvious to everyone else.

Pode asks its unlikely pair to help each other through a mountain. I explained that a star should naturally receive the larger dressing room. Tank pointed out that we were in a cave and neither of us had a dressing room. Shawna gave my imaginary agent a pebble to sit on.

The interesting thing happened when we stopped discussing which character mattered more. One ability opened a possibility the other could use. My magnificent glow was useless in the wrong place; Tank's patient presence had practical consequences.

Rosa watched us rehearse a route with two salt shakers. 'Try asking where he needs you.' I did. For several beautiful seconds, I contributed without announcing a new era. Then I demanded a commemorative photograph, and the rock declined to comment.

The actual attraction

A rock and a fallen star explore Norwegian-inspired caverns, using different abilities to bring an ancient environment to life and solve spatial puzzles. The Switch edition supports one or two players on one system.

The catch worth knowing

You still move characters through three-dimensional spaces and coordinate their positions and abilities. The store's cooperative and gentle-looking presentation does not prove no held movement, no tricky jumps or no timed sections throughout. The assigned edition is Switch; PC controller requirements are not imported here.

An opening invitation

Try the first shared room and let each person explain what their character appears able to change. Check movement, positioning and the viewpoint before tackling a long puzzle. Switch roles only if both people would like to.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Recommended conditionally for a pair curious about complementary talents; the rock's refusal to attend my press conference counts as sound geological judgement.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/pode-switch/>

P204 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Stardew Valley

The Farm's First Crop Is an Unnecessary Spreadsheet

Edition considered: PC current release; platform and version must be recorded

I arrived in Stardew Valley with a five-year agricultural strategy and no clear understanding of where I had put the hoe. The first field was assigned to revenue optimisation. The second was reserved for a statue commemorating the first.

Rosa wanted a little garden. Tank wanted to see the town. Mercedes wanted to know why my spreadsheet had already made everyone late for something that had not happened.

The valley contains neighbours, seasons, crops and opportunities to become busy. I interpreted this as permission to run the farm like a minor empire. Shawna placed one seed packet over the spreadsheet and asked what we actually wanted to do together.

We settled on a small patch and a walk. I struggled with the modest scale of our success until a plant became more interesting than my projected margins. The statue remained unbuilt. Several residents benefited from never learning that it had been proposed, which I recorded as a community relations achievement.

The actual attraction

Farming, friendships, seasons, crafting and exploration create a place that can grow alongside a group. The current inspected PC listing advertises online cooperation and shared-screen support, allowing genuine joint work rather than only discussion beside one controller.

The catch worth knowing

An active day, energy, inventories, travel, fishing and combat create different demands. Multiplayer pause behavior must be checked; a partner does not automatically stop the clock. Many recipes and social schedules can turn leisure into planning. Record the actual installed version before comparing features.

An opening invitation

Plant a small patch or take one walk together. Inspect movement, item selection and what happens to time when a menu opens. Avoid choosing a mining or fishing challenge as the sole measure of whether village life appeals.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally welcome when a farm sounds like a place to visit, not another dashboard; my statue may remain theoretical indefinitely.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/413150/>

P205 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Minecraft

The Cathedral Has No Door Because I Began with the Spire

Edition considered: Java & Bedrock Edition for PC; editions need separate control profiles

I chose Minecraft's Creative mode and began a cathedral dedicated to my own surprisingly modest ambitions. Its spire could be seen from almost anywhere. Its entrance could be seen from nowhere, because I had forgotten to build one.

Tank made a doorway. Rosa made a little seating area. Mercedes added a window that improved the building so much I briefly considered calling it my original intention.

The blocks gave us something to discuss that was neither a score nor my architectural reputation. Shawna tried the camera, placed a few pieces and decided that the movement itself deserved attention before we expanded the project.

I proposed a grand opening. Nobody wanted another ceremony. We sat inside the unfinished structure and looked out of Mercedes's window. The view contained a hill, a tree and no explanation of my achievements. I admitted it was rather good. Tank offered to build a plaque saying AIDEN EVENTUALLY FOUND THE DOOR, but Rosa persuaded him that the doorway already made the point.

The actual attraction

Creative mode supplies unlimited resources, damage immunity and flight for shared building. Java and Bedrock both support multiplayer, but they have different compatibility and input profiles. A modest construction can give two people an enjoyable shared purpose.

The catch worth knowing

Moving while steering a three-dimensional view and precisely placing blocks can be substantial work. Creative mode changes survival pressure, not those demands. Official comparison lists controller support for Bedrock, not Java, and split-screen only on consoles; do not plan PC couch split-screen.

An opening invitation

Choose the exact edition and arrange compatible separate-device play if sharing online or locally. In Creative mode, try looking around and placing a few blocks before planning anything large. A wall with one window is an adequate architectural brief.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional building invitation when the camera feels comfortable; all cathedrals must demonstrate a functioning entrance before accepting my name.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.minecraft.net/en-us/about-minecraft>

P206 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Animal Crossing: New Horizons

The Island Has Elected Somebody Else to Relax

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

I stepped onto the island and announced a comprehensive beautification programme. First would come a triumphal avenue. Then a plaza. Then a tasteful plaque explaining why the avenue and plaza were named after the same unusually deserving person.

Rosa picked up a shell and said she liked the beach as it was. Tank found somewhere to sit. Mercedes asked whether my plan included a district where nobody had to listen to a plan.

Animal Crossing: New Horizons made room for collecting, decorating and visiting. I tried to convert those possibilities into a compulsory itinerary. Shawna gently returned the itinerary to the binder, where it could inconvenience only the other paper.

We spent a while looking at things. I discovered a particularly excellent spot for a bench and nearly ruined it by calling it an urban planning breakthrough. Instead, I asked who wanted to choose the bench. The island survived this astonishing decentralisation, and my imaginary mayoral sash was repurposed as a ribbon for the picnic basket.

The actual attraction

Collect materials, meet animal neighbours and gradually arrange an island home. The current Switch page supports up to four people sharing one system and larger visits with separate systems, though these are different ways of playing together.

The catch worth knowing

Crafting, tool selection, storage and repeated dialogue can create menu work. Same-system roles and restrictions deserve a practical check before assuming everyone has identical freedom. The page reflects current updates, so check the installed version; this card does not certify every activity as untimed.

An opening invitation

Walk around, talk to one neighbour and try placing or collecting an object. If playing together, test the specific visiting or shared-system mode and let both people describe what they can actually do. An unproductive beach stroll is a valid result.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising in spirit but conditional in operation: approved for people who want an island, with no requirement to elect me its visionary.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/animal-crossing-new-horizons-switch/>

P207 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Portal 2

The Test Chamber Has Rejected My Motivational Poster

Edition considered: PC release

I brought Portal 2 a motivational poster reading THINK OUTSIDE THE BOX. Tank looked at the test chamber and asked whether I had considered locating the box first.

I proposed that one robot provide inspiration while the other handled buttons, portals and the inconvenient business of survival. Shawna said that sounded suspiciously like our old office arrangement. Mercedes assigned me the next physical task before I could establish a leadership exception.

The pleasure of a cooperative chamber is that two perspectives can become one solution. The less pleasant discovery was that my perspective included repeatedly looking at the wrong ceiling. Tank described the actual panel. I followed his description and, for once, improved the situation.

The poster eventually became a useful diagram on its reverse side. Rosa drew the two portal colours clearly and asked what information each of us needed. We had a plan rather than a slogan. This offended my communications department but worked considerably better.

The actual attraction

The dedicated two-player campaign has its own robots, story and chambers designed around joint portal solutions. Humour and mechanical discoveries make it attractive to companions who like discussing how a space works.

The catch worth knowing

First-person movement, aiming, spatial transformations and coordinating actions remain substantial catches. Steam declares play without timed input, but that declaration is not a tested guarantee that every cooperative manoeuvre avoids urgency or awkward timing. Both camera comfort and joint execution need direct trials.

An opening invitation

Enter the cooperative introduction and test looking, walking and placing a portal before pursuing a complex solution. Describe a location without pointing at the other person's screen. Stop if the camera or required coordination outweighs the pleasure of solving.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional laboratory visit for two people who enjoy spatial reasoning; motivational posters must earn their wall space by becoming diagrams.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/620/>

P208 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Untitled Goose Game

My Public Relations Department Is Two Geese

Edition considered: PC release with two-player update

I hired two geese to improve the office's public image. The first stole my pen. The second honked during the phrase stakeholder confidence. Their invoice, had they issued one, would have been impeccable satire.

Untitled Goose Game gives two players a village in which to collaborate on mischief. I admired the efficiency of a plan that could be communicated through waddling and the removal of somebody else's hat.

Shawna asked whether I preferred operating the goose or telling everyone where it should go. This was a difficult distinction for a man who had recently called a traffic cone his deputy. Tank took the other role and waited while I examined the surroundings instead of rushing the next prank.

Rosa reminded us that only fictional gardeners were available for harassment. My attempt to honk at the actual kettle received no institutional support. Mercedes returned the stolen pen and gave the geese my job description. They appeared fully qualified.

The actual attraction

The updated PC game lets two people play the whole village prank campaign together. Watching people react, coordinating distractions and creating ridiculous little situations can be as entertaining as completing the written objectives.

The catch worth knowing

Stealth, pursuit, object handling and positioning operate in real time. Some tasks require observing routines and acting at a useful moment; held inputs and later time challenges need checking. A charming goose is still capable of making a control scheme demanding.

An opening invitation

Explore the first garden together and try moving, honking and handling one object before attempting an elaborate prank. Agree whether either person wants hints. Enjoy an accidental comic moment without turning every task into a performance target.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Admitted when shared mischief sounds better than shared productivity; the geese have already exceeded my department's annual honesty forecast.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/837470/>

P209 / DETOUR / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Unravel Two

The Leadership Retreat Is Tangled Around a Table Leg

Edition considered: PC release

I connected two lengths of yarn to demonstrate the strength of partnership. Within a minute, one was around a chair, the other was under the printer, and my sleeve had become an unofficial third participant.

Unravel Two's little companions face a more beautiful version of the same practical question: how do connected bodies help each other move? I suggested that I could provide vision while Tank provided traction. Tank suggested that I untie the printer.

The game looked like a lovely invitation to cooperate. Shawna kept the movement demands visible: jumping, swinging, running and finding a route together were part of the invitation too. A soft-looking character did not soften every landing.

Rosa brought scissors for our physical demonstration and asked us to stop turning metaphor into a tripping hazard. Mercedes freed my sleeve. The partnership survived, although its first documented success was allowing everyone to reach the snacks without crawling. I considered commissioning a tapestry. The committee advised against more yarn.

The actual attraction

Two Yarnys work through natural and built environments, helping one another across obstacles. Native local cooperation makes the physical connection between characters a direct shared puzzle, with an emotional story running through the journey.

The catch worth knowing

This is an active platforming game: jumping, swinging, running and reaction demands are explicit. Coordination can amplify frustration when one person wants a slower pace. Its warmth does not establish an easy route through every chase or challenge; check any assistance options in the actual build.

An opening invitation

In an early safe area, each person should try movement and one simple shared traversal. Ask whether being physically linked feels funny and satisfying or restrictive. Do not make completing a chase the admission test for an enjoyable evening.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A deliberate action detour for companions who want movement as part of the fun; the office printer has declined to become a Yarny.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1225570/>

P210 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: no

80 Days

Eighty Days, Seventy-Nine Hatboxes

Edition considered: PC release

I packed for a journey around the world with one useful coat and seventy-nine containers of ceremonial importance. Tank asked what was in the largest box. I said the smaller boxes needed a dignified entrance.

In 80 Days, routes, money, luggage and a companion's needs make travel a sequence of interesting compromises. My first proposed itinerary involved visiting every city that might appreciate my hat. Shawna calculated that this would take substantially longer than the wager allowed.

Mercedes wanted to follow an intriguing conversation. Rosa wanted to know whether we could afford the next connection. Both concerns proved more engaging than my luggage manifesto.

We reduced the baggage and chose a direction together. Nobody pretended the decision had become certain merely because two people discussed it. I retained one excellent hat and discovered that an unexpected encounter could justify a detour. Tank carried the map, largely to prevent me replacing the continents with a diagram of my personal brand.

The actual attraction

As Passepartout, choose routes and encounters across an alternate-history world while managing Fogg's wellbeing, money and travel. This is single-player storytelling that can be discussed beside the screen; its shared appeal does not make it native cooperative play.

The catch worth knowing

The premise includes a travel deadline, schedules and an in-game clock. The inspected store language stresses continuous time, so do not assume a fully untimed experience or confuse the multiplayer journey feed with joint control. Reading, inventory and route planning are significant.

An opening invitation

Inspect the opening route choices and how time behaves in each screen before committing to a journey. Let the person operating choose whether advice is welcome. One interesting encounter is enough to assess the prose and decision rhythm.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally approved for armchair travellers who enjoy a consequential itinerary; my hatboxes may circle the globe separately at their own expense.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/381780/>

The Friend Who Became a Tutorial

I discovered an extraordinary gift for cooperative instruction. Whatever Tank was doing, I could describe how I would have done it three seconds earlier. This service required no controller and, apparently, no correct information.

“Go left,” I said.

He went left.

“Your other left.”

Tank paused the discussion by looking at me. It was not a pause button; it was a face. The distinction mattered because I had already become confident enough to promise features I had not checked.

Shawna put a small card beside the screen. It read ASK.

“Ask what?”

“Whether he wants help.”

“He clearly needs - ”

She tapped the card.

I asked. Tank said he wanted to try the thing. So I let him try the thing. A door opened. I immediately felt the urge to explain that his method had been broadly consistent with my strategy. Mercedes placed a sandwich directly in my hand. It was a merciful intervention.

Later, in a different puzzle, Tank asked what I could see. I described a shape, its position, and the marks beside it. He compared those with his own information. For once my mouth was connected to an actual function. We made progress by building a shared description, not by making one person into the other's remote-control accessory.

Rosa noticed the difference first. “You two sound like you're enjoying it.”

I wanted to issue a certificate. Shawna pointed at the ASK card. I did not ask whether they wanted a certificate because some impulses deserve to be carried privately until they pass.

We adjusted the room instead. The screen moved so both people could see. A lamp stopped reflecting across a clue. The water came closer. None of that changed the software, and none magically erased a game's real demands. It simply removed three problems I had accidentally supplied for free.

The binder contained some excellent candidates for shared thinking that were still single-player games. We kept that plain. Taking turns at a puzzle could be enjoyable, but it was not the same as two simultaneous characters. Watching a friend play could be a pleasure, but it was not automatically participation. A guest could prefer to watch, offer a theory, take a turn, or go make tea. The room could accommodate all four without assigning ranks.

The red stapler disappeared during this discussion. I suspected theft. Rosa found it beneath my elbow.

“You are the obstacle in more systems than you realize,” she said.

I returned it to its tray. Then I moved my elbow, my advice, and my magnificent self far enough back that the next person could reach the controls.

P211 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: yes

The Past Within

My Future Self Has Misfiled the Past

Edition considered: PC release; two devices required

I offered to be the future in *The Past Within* because I felt my achievements belonged there. Tank accepted the past on condition that he would not be held responsible for anything I eventually did with the stationery budget.

Our two screens did not contain the same information. I began describing a symbol as a triumphant shape of inevitable progress. Shawna asked whether it was a triangle. It was a triangle.

The puzzle improved when I stopped narrating my importance and started reporting useful details. Tank told me what he saw. I repeated it back. For a remarkable moment, neither of us accused the other of having the wrong screen.

Rosa supplied paper for notes; Mercedes vetoed a twenty-page communication protocol. The spooky Vanderboom mystery continued without our administrative assistance. I did, however, send a warning to my future self about leaving biscuit crumbs in the keyboard. The future offered no assurances, which seemed entirely consistent with its record so far.

The actual attraction

Two players occupy different times and exchange information to solve a Rusty Lake mystery. Separate perspectives make describing, listening and comparing observations the actual cooperative activity rather than a decorative addition to a solo puzzle.

The catch worth knowing

This is co-op only: each player needs their own copy, a device and a way to communicate. Eerie imagery and puzzling symbols may be unwelcome. Reading, remembering descriptions and manipulating the interface still need checking; the premise does not establish a complete absence of timed or held actions.

An opening invitation

Set up both perspectives and exchange one precise observation before pursuing a solution. Try any unfamiliar interaction separately. Decide whether the pleasure comes from explaining what you see, and whether either person wants brief written notes.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approved conditionally for a pair who enjoy saying what is actually on their screens; triumphant shapes of inevitable progress should first be checked for three sides.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1515210/>

P212 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Kirby and the Forgotten Land

Kirby Inhales My Entire Presentation

Edition considered: 2022 Nintendo Switch original; not Switch 2 Star-Crossed World edition

I had just reached slide seventeen when Kirby inhaled the projector. This was not a feature I could promise from the actual game, but as a fantasy of office reform it held obvious merit.

Kirby and the Forgotten Land offered us an overgrown world and two different roles. I wanted to be the star. Tank wanted to know which role allowed him to get on with the game while I explained that desire.

Shawna put the controllers down long enough to settle it properly. One person could play Kirby, the other Bandana Waddle Dee; the characters were not interchangeable job titles. Mercedes suggested we try both before I established a constitutional monarchy.

Rosa liked the town and wanted time to look around. The adventure also contained fights and challenges. We agreed that the pinkness of the hero was not evidence about the difficulty of every action. My slides were quietly retired. Kirby received credit for a productivity improvement he had achieved only inside my extremely selective imagination.

The actual attraction

Explore three-dimensional stages, rescue Waddle Dees and develop a town between adventures. Original Switch local cooperation adds Bandana Waddle Dee beside Kirby. Nintendo's Spring-Breeze mode gives more health and easier enemies.

The catch worth knowing

This remains platforming and combat. Nintendo explicitly describes timed Treasure Road challenges and abilities involving held buttons, such as charging a hammer or aiming a bomb. The second role differs. The 2022 Switch original is assessed here, not the Switch 2 expansion or upgrade.

An opening invitation

Try the opening area in Spring-Breeze mode if desired, testing movement and each character's basic actions. Check whether both people like their role before pursuing a boss or time challenge. The official page lists a demo, whose current availability can be checked on the console.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional expedition when active movement sounds appealing; the committee cannot legally list projector consumption as an accessibility option.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirby-and-the-forgotten-land-switch/>

P213 / **CONDITIONAL** / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe

Four Kirbys Apply for the Same Corner Office

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch Deluxe edition

Once I learned we could have several Kirbys, I declared the corner office insufficiently cornered. Four distinguished heroes would require four distinguished views. Tank rotated the table and said the problem was solved.

Return to Dream Land Deluxe gives a group more character choices than my original seating plan. I announced that everyone could choose freely, then delivered a speech about why my preferred choice naturally carried executive authority.

Shawna selected a character before the speech finished. Mercedes selected another. Rosa asked whether the little cosmic traveller needed his ship repaired or merely a committee to discuss the damage.

The actual adventure required moving, fighting and helping. It also offered Helper Magolor, which seemed a better practical resource than my motivational remarks. I tried to appoint myself Helper Aiden. Tank handed me the refreshments and told me I had finally identified a useful role. The ship remained fictional, but the tea arrived at a sensible temperature and without a ceremonial launch.

The actual attraction

The Deluxe Switch platform adventure supports up to four local players, including different Kirbys and familiar companions. Repairing Magolor's ship gives the group a shared journey, while character abilities and separate subgames provide variety.

The catch worth knowing

Floating, fighting, jumps and different move sets remain active demands. Nintendo confirms Helper Magolor for the main adventure, but that does not erase every challenge. The later Magolor Epilogue must be unlocked and has its own action; do not treat all modes as equivalent.

An opening invitation

Use an early main-adventure section to test movement and a character's basic ability. Examine Helper Magolor if helpful. Leave competitive subgames and coordinated team attacks for later, and keep the first shared session free from a completion target.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally suitable for a group that wants colourful action with some assistance; four Kirbys do not require four separate speeches about my chair.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirbys-return-to-dream-land-deluxe-switch/>

P214 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Super Mario Bros. Wonder

The Flower Has More Stage Presence Than I Do

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

I entered the Flower Kingdom prepared to be the most surprising object in the room. A talking flower immediately challenged that assumption. Then the landscape began doing things my planning documents had failed to anticipate.

Super Mario Bros. Wonder seemed determined to make curiosity physical. I attempted to preserve my dignity by explaining every new transformation as if I had personally authorised it. Mercedes asked me to let the surprise finish before taking credit.

Shawna considered the different characters. Nabbit and Yoshis avoided enemy damage, which sounded useful, but the courses still needed moving through. Tank asked whether I understood the difference between protection and the ground continuing beneath one's feet. My recent relationship with the office step stool suggested further research.

Rosa chose the character she liked. We agreed to travel at a pace the group could actually share. I put away the stopwatch I had brought for my triumphal entrance, and the talking flower continued its career without needing to chair a single meeting.

The actual attraction

Side-scrolling courses change in imaginative ways when Wonder effects appear. Up to four local players can tackle them together. Nabbit and Yoshis avoid damage from enemies, and Yoshis can carry other players.

The catch worth knowing

Running, jumping, gaps, moving hazards and coordination remain part of an action game. Enemy-damage protection does not certify an effortless or no-hold path through every course. Character restrictions also matter: Nintendo says Nabbit and Yoshis do not transform with power-ups.

An opening invitation

Pick characters for their actual appeal and try one early course without collecting every optional item. Check movement and jump controls before introducing extra badges. A companion should match the agreed pace rather than racing ahead to demonstrate expertise.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A cheerful conditional action choice when surprises and jumps are welcome; the flower's speaking engagement has priority over my ribbon-cutting ceremony.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/super-mario-bros-wonder-switch/>

P215 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: yes

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two

Two Clocks and One Man Who Cannot Describe a Drawer

Edition considered: PC release; two-device format

I opened the clockmaker's mystery with the confidence of somebody who owned a watch he did not know how to adjust. Tank was given the other screen and immediately encountered information I did not have.

I described a drawer as antique, purposeful and carrying the weight of untold history. Shawna asked whether it was open. It was not. She asked what was on it. I had somehow omitted that part.

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two rewarded the details my dramatic training usually treated as beneath notice. A mark, a position, a sequence: these could help another person. My atmospheric interpretation could wait until we had located the relevant object.

Mercedes established a temporary ban on the phrase time itself. Rosa said either of us could ask for a description again without making it a test. We began to work together. I still admired the watch on my wrist, although it remained impressively accurate about a completely different hour.

The actual attraction

Separate screens hold pieces of an eerie clockwork mystery, and two people combine what they see to escape. The developer describes cross-platform play, so communication rather than a shared physical controller is the central partnership.

The catch worth knowing

It requires two players and separate devices; check the exact copies and setup needed on the chosen platforms. Describing symbols and retaining another person's clues can be demanding. The clock imagery and promotional urgency do not establish the actual timer behavior; inspect it directly.

An opening invitation

Choose the two perspectives and compare one visible clue. Try describing shape, location and order before proposing a theory. Establish that asking for a repeat is ordinary cooperation, then see whether the eerie atmosphere adds pleasure or merely pressure.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally recommended for two people who enjoy exchanging useful observations; my drawer must supply identifying details before receiving another historical monologue.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/790740/>

P216 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Captain Toad: Treasure Tracker

Captain Toad Audits My Suitcase

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch version

I packed for a small treasure hunt with a ceremonial telescope, three waistcoats and a collapsible lectern. Captain Toad's heavy backpack suddenly seemed an entirely reasonable professional arrangement.

The little stages encouraged looking from another angle. I initially interpreted this as advice to photograph myself from the left. Tank rotated our cardboard model and revealed the passage I had been talking over for five minutes.

Shawna suggested checking the actual viewpoint controls before declaring the adventure serene. There were hazards in these small places; their compactness did not make them imaginary. Mercedes wanted to know what the second player would actually do in the installed version, a question my brochure had replaced with a picture of two smiling hats.

Rosa removed the lectern from my luggage. With fewer things to carry, I could inspect the model properly. The treasure had been behind a folded corner all along. I announced that this vindicated my patient investigative method. Everyone present had a more accurate, less printable description.

The actual attraction

Compact three-dimensional courses invite you to inspect routes, hidden items and mechanisms from different angles. The Switch release includes two-player support, making it a possible shared puzzle expedition once the actual roles and update level are clear.

The catch worth knowing

Camera rotation, hazards, aiming and some moving challenges remain relevant. Nintendo's current product text describes second-player turnip assistance and newer features separately; verify the installed version's cooperative roles rather than assuming identical control. This card excludes VR and separately sold extra stages.

An opening invitation

Explore an early course and rotate the view deliberately before moving near a hazard. Try the second-player role on the actual console. Ask whether discovering a route together feels satisfying and whether the camera is comfortable.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional choice for people who enjoy examining a miniature world; my lectern must remain at base camp with the rest of the unnecessary equipment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/captain-toad-treasure-tracker-switch/>

P217 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Yoshi's Crafted World

The Cardboard Scenery Has Filed a Complaint About My Budget

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

I proposed a scenery budget involving imported stone and professional lighting. Yoshi's Crafted World answered with paper cups, boxes and an imagination that made my proposal look both expensive and rather embarrassed.

Rosa constructed a little house from a biscuit carton. Tank made a bridge. Mercedes turned an ordinary lid into a view I would have described as internationally significant if I had thought of it first.

The game let a pair of Yoshis explore a handmade world, including different perspectives on its stages. I became fascinated by what a familiar object could suggest when treated playfully. Shawna became fascinated by whether the aiming and jumping felt comfortable, an equally valid form of curiosity.

We looked at Mellow mode rather than making assumptions from the soft scenery. I then tried to improve Rosa's carton house by adding my initials to the roof. She removed the initials and left the house. This was the strongest architectural review my office had received all week.

The actual attraction

Everyday craft materials become a playful landscape for two local Yoshis. Collecting objects and seeing stages from the reverse side can turn a familiar route into a fresh observation game. Mellow mode gives Yoshi wings.

The catch worth knowing

Jumping, aiming, enemies and movement still exist, and searching for every collectible can add repeated travel. Wings change part of the challenge; they do not prove every input is comfortable or every sequence untimed. Both players should test their controls rather than relying on the handmade appearance.

An opening invitation

Try an opening section, with Mellow mode if desired, and practise one jump and one aimed action. Enjoy the scenery without making complete collection a requirement. Let either player decide that looking together is more pleasant than controlling a character.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally admitted for people charmed by ingenious craft scenery; the imported stone has been cancelled and the biscuit carton promoted on merit.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/yoshis-crafted-world-switch/>

P218 / **CONDITIONAL** / directional input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Snipperclips - Cut it out, together!

My Partner Has Trimmed the Leadership Out of Me

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game; Plus expansion separate

I thought Snipperclips sounded like a useful workshop on refining a shared vision. Then I learned the partners could literally cut one another into more useful shapes, and the room became alarmingly interested.

Tank suggested removing my ceremonial shoulder pads first. Shawna suggested removing the paragraph in which I explained why I needed them. Mercedes asked whether we could trim an entire job title.

The actual paper characters needed to overlap, rotate and cooperate. My first imaginary cut produced a shape excellent at announcing an intention and completely unable to perform it. Rosa turned the scrap sideways and found a use for it anyway.

We began asking before making a change. That improved both our puzzle and our paper casualties. I discovered that helping somebody become the shape they wanted was more enjoyable than cutting them into the assistant I had planned. My shoulder pads remained intact in real life, but their annual funding faced an unusually serious review.

The actual attraction

Partners reshape paper characters to interact with objects and solve physical puzzles. The Switch base game includes cooperative play; its competitive Blitz activities and larger Party challenges are distinct choices, not one uniform experience.

The catch worth knowing

Precise overlap, rotation, movement and manipulating unstable objects can take repeated attempts. Some modes are action-focused. The cheerful visual style does not establish no holds or no urgency, and the Plus expansion should not be assumed to be part of the base release.

An opening invitation

Begin with an ordinary cooperative puzzle, test how cutting and restoring a shape work, and agree before cutting the other character. See whether the shared experimentation is funny even when it fails. Leave competitive activities out of the initial trial.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Approved conditionally for friends who enjoy negotiating a practical shape; my shoulder pads may be discussed, but no physical scissors are authorised.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/snipperclips-cut-it-out-together-switch/>

P219 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Blanc

The Snow Has Covered My Footprint Branding

Edition considered: PC release

I planned to leave a distinctive trail through the snow: confident steps, recognisable silhouette, perhaps a monogram at regular intervals. Tank pointed out that a sensible trail should first help someone find where they were going.

Blanc follows a wolf cub and a fawn through a snowstorm. Their different strengths mattered more than either animal's public profile. I tried to assign one as Chief Journey Officer. Mercedes asked whether the wolf had requested a promotion.

The wordless scenes gave us room to notice weather, movement and the other creature's needs. Shawna tested the actual actions, because two buttons plus movement still meant positioning a body in a space. Rosa wanted both animals to reach their families, not to win an argument about who was carrying the story.

I abandoned the monogrammed trail. We followed the footprints together and let the picture speak. For once, the absence of my commentary seemed like an additional environmental feature rather than a technical failure.

The actual attraction

A wolf cub and a fawn travel through a hand-drawn black-and-white landscape, following their families' traces and using complementary abilities. The PC release supports local and online cooperation, with text-free storytelling.

The catch worth knowing

The developer describes two buttons plus movement, but a small button count does not settle coordination, precision, repetition or held movement. Navigation and obstacles still need both players. Separation and harsh weather give the gentle artwork an emotional edge.

An opening invitation

Move each animal through the opening space and try its first useful action. Check whether the viewpoint and character positions are easy to read together. Agree that either person can request a pause or a repeated explanation without apologising.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional snowy journey for companions who enjoy communicating through action and observation; all footprint monograms have been denied on grounds of navigational vanity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1982340/>

P220 / PROMISING / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Hidden Through Time

History Has Hidden My Keys in Plain Sight

Edition considered: PC first game

I claimed exceptional powers of observation while standing directly in front of the keys I was looking for. Tank let the claim develop for another sentence before pointing at my coat pocket.

Hidden Through Time offered a less humiliating form of searching: busy illustrated scenes, clues and little objects waiting to be noticed. I announced that I would divide the picture into administrative zones. Rosa noticed something while I was still naming Zone One.

Mercedes preferred wandering with her eyes. Shawna wanted to read the hint carefully. Both methods produced more progress than my proposed Department of Sequential Looking.

We made a rule that anybody could point out a discovery, but nobody had to race. It turned out that sharing a picture did not require inventing native cooperative controls. One person could operate while the others enjoyed the search. I found an object and accepted the achievement with reasonable restraint, which in my case meant a speech shorter than the clue.

The actual attraction

Search colourful scenes for hidden objects across historical settings, using hints and visual detail. The PC game also offers a map editor and community creations, though the initial appeal can simply be one busy picture enjoyed together.

The catch worth knowing

Dense scenes, small objects and repeated scanning may be the main burden. Zooming, panning and clicking deserve direct checks; a hidden-object premise does not establish a complete no-timer or no-hold path. The inspected product lists single-player: shared looking is not verified native co-op.

An opening invitation

Open one ordinary scene and inspect a clue, a small object and the available view controls. Search without a race or a requirement to clear the whole picture. Ask whether the artwork makes looking pleasant before adding community maps.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A plausible shared-screen choice when noticing tiny details sounds enjoyable; Zone One remains under investigation, mostly because I have misplaced its sign.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/524910/>

P221 / PROMISING / camera input / pace: waits / native co-op: unknown

Tiny Lands

The Two Desks Differ Mainly in My Story About Them

Edition considered: PC first game

I presented two pictures of the office and challenged everyone to find the difference. In one, I was pretending to work. In the other, I had moved the pretence three inches to the left.

Tiny Lands offered more charming dioramas and less obvious evidence. We could turn the scenes and inspect what changed. Rosa noticed a small detail while I was constructing an elaborate theory about the political meaning of a fence.

The game explicitly removes a time limit and punishment for mistakes. This left me with no excuse for declaring an observation emergency. Tank settled into his chair and examined the scene from another angle. Mercedes said the little world looked like somewhere a person might actually enjoy visiting.

Shawna checked the rotation and zoom. Those operations mattered more than my assertion that calm scenery guaranteed calm controls. We found another difference. I celebrated by leaving the room exactly as it was, a rare administrative decision that improved its prospects of remaining tidy.

The actual attraction

Rotate and compare miniature three-dimensional scenes to find their differences. The publisher explicitly states that there is no time limit and no penalty for mistakes, making patient shared observation a plausible way to enjoy it.

The catch worth knowing

The scenes still require visual discrimination, zooming and rotation. Check whether the actual camera manipulation uses uncomfortable holds or drags. The inspected description presents a single-player comparison game; shared looking is an informal arrangement, even though Remote Play Together appears among store features.

An opening invitation

Compare one pair of scenes at whatever pace feels pleasant. Rotate once, zoom once and make an uncertain selection to understand the feedback. Nobody needs to find every difference before deciding whether the artwork and observation suit the mood.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising for an evening of small discoveries without a race; the committee accepts that both photographs of my desk may contain the same unfinished work.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Tiny Lands Steam publisher description explicitly states no time limit and no punishment for mistakes, and describes adjustable angle and zoom. Single-player comparison is explicit; Remote Play Together is not treated as proof of native cooperative roles. Held/dragged camera input remains to check.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1354910/>

P222 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

PHOGS!

Two Heads, One Belly, No Agreement About Lunch

Edition considered: PC release

I regarded a double-ended dog as an elegant solution to the problem of attending two meetings at once. Tank regarded it as an elegant reason never to schedule two meetings.

PHOGS! connected our characters through a stretchy middle. I wanted to investigate a distinguished-looking object. Tank wanted to investigate food. The body between us offered a firm critique of unilateral leadership.

Shawna suggested that before pulling, we explain where we hoped to go. This caused a brief silence while I adjusted to the possibility that direction could be negotiated. Mercedes put a little hat on our imaginary dog and said dignity was already a lost cause, so we might as well enjoy ourselves.

The game had worlds of food, sleep and play. Rosa approved of the agenda more than she had approved of any agenda I had ever printed. We practised cooperating without treating each tug as an argument. I still attempted to appoint my end the official spokesperson. The other end barked, and the minutes recorded a tie.

The actual attraction

Red and Blue stretch, grab and bounce through physics puzzles in food, sleep and play worlds. The PC release explicitly supports local and online co-op as well as single-player and shared-controller arrangements.

The catch worth knowing

Two connected heads create funny movement but also coordination demands. Grabbing, stretching, positioning and repeated physical attempts can matter more than the cheerful setting suggests. Check the chosen controller arrangement and any holds directly; shared-controller play is a separate configuration, not automatically the easiest one.

An opening invitation

Try moving toward one object together and agree which head will act first. Test grabbing and releasing before pursuing a larger challenge. Judge whether accidental entanglement feels playful or irritating, and adjust the partnership rather than blaming either person.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional invitation for companions who can laugh at a body with competing lunch plans; neither head receives permanent executive authority.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/850320/>

P223 / CONDITIONAL / directional input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Pikuniku

The Revolution Has Extremely Unreliable Knees

Edition considered: PC release; co-op levels separate from solo story

I arrived in Pikuniku's world prepared to issue a stirring proclamation. My long-legged representative moved in a way that made solemnity practically impossible. Tank laughed before I reached the part about our shared destiny.

The bright setting concealed a more suspicious arrangement than its simple shapes first suggested. I admired a story that could be silly and still have something to say about power. Shawna admired a game that clearly separated its solo campaign from custom cooperative levels, a distinction my brochure had tried to squeeze into a decorative footnote.

Mercedes asked whether we wanted the story or the two-player physical puzzles tonight. Rosa said we could decide without consulting a national strategy.

I attempted a dignified kick during our imaginary rehearsal and knocked my own ceremonial sign over. The revolution benefited immediately from having one less proclamation to read. Tank offered to print a new sign, but only if it said LOOK WHERE YOUR LEGS ARE GOING. I reluctantly admitted this was a useful policy platform.

The actual attraction

A deliberately silly puzzle-exploration adventure pairs peculiar characters with a story about a deceptively cheerful dystopia. The separate local cooperative levels offer a different way to enjoy its physical comedy with another player.

The catch worth knowing

The story campaign is not the same as the dedicated co-op challenges. Movement, jumping, kicking and physical timing can require active coordination. Do not infer an untimed or hold-free experience from the simple drawings or the description's invitation to explore at your own pace.

An opening invitation

First decide whether the goal is shared story viewing or actual two-player puzzles. Try one short movement section in that mode and see whether the comic physics are enjoyable. Leave progress targets aside while testing the basic legwork.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally approved when absurd movement is part of the appeal; the committee recognises LOOK WHERE YOUR LEGS ARE GOING as my first fully implementable revolutionary demand.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/572890/>

P224 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Overboard!

The Murderer Has Requested a More Flattering Alibi

Edition considered: PC release

I boarded the fictional liner with a plan to conduct a dignified investigation. Overboard! immediately complicated matters by making the player responsible for the murder. I asked whether the minutes could describe it as an unfortunate passenger reduction.

'No,' said everyone, with unusual procedural efficiency.

The interesting work became arranging what other people knew, saw and believed. I practised an alibi involving a tea tray, a minor celebrity and a speech nobody remembered hearing. Tank said the absence of witnesses to one of my speeches was the least believable part.

Shawna tracked where the characters were going while Mercedes questioned the story I wanted them to accept. Rosa reminded us that enjoying a fictional schemer did not require becoming one over dinner.

We treated the narrative as a shared puzzle with one person choosing. My final alibi was shorter, better and still deeply suspicious. The gold stamp marked it RECEIVED, which I was disappointed to learn was not the same as ACQUITTED.

The actual attraction

You play the culprit on a 1930s liner and try to escape justice through conversations, lies and manipulation. Characters remember events and move independently, making a replayed situation reveal new possibilities. A companion can discuss schemes beside the single-player screen.

The catch worth knowing

The story gives you eight in-game hours, with schedules and missed opportunities creating pressure. The inspected description does not resolve every real-time or pause detail, so test how the clock advances. Reading, remembering movements and replaying failed plans are central burdens.

An opening invitation

Inspect the first choices and clock behavior before pursuing an elaborate cover story. Discuss one possible explanation only if the player wants advice. Decide whether mischievous replay and moral inversion feel entertaining rather than exhausting.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally suitable for people who enjoy a fictional alibi unravelling; the committee's stamp cannot issue acquittals, refunds or immunity from Tank's questions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1546920/>

P225 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: no

Expelled!

The Headmistress Has Read My Reference Letter

Edition considered: PC release

I applied to a distinguished school using a reference letter I had written myself. It praised my honesty in a font large enough to conceal the missing signature. Mercedes said the application had already developed a motive.

Expelled! places its heroine in a much more urgent predicament: accused of attempted murder, she has a school day to change the outcome. I proposed solving everything by making an excellent impression on the authorities. Shawna asked how that had worked for my unsigned letter.

The game's web of gossip, secrets and remembered actions invited a different approach. Tank wanted to compare what people claimed with what they had actually seen. Rosa wanted us to keep the difference between fictional scheming and real hospitality firmly intact.

I drafted a plan with seven contingencies and no realistic understanding of the timetable. We reduced it to one useful question. For once, the investigation advanced faster after my management document became smaller. The headmistress, had she existed, would probably still have wanted a word with me.

The actual attraction

Verity Amersham navigates a 1922 boarding school after being accused of attempted murder. Conversations, secrets and manipulation reshape the day, offering a replayable narrative puzzle that can invite lively discussion from an optional companion.

The catch worth knowing

One school day limits the investigation, and characters act on what they witness. The official description's ticking-clock language establishes schedule pressure, not a verified rule for every paused screen. Expect reading, route memory and potentially unpleasant choices; it remains a single-player game.

An opening invitation

Inspect the opening accusation and the timetable or clock as presented. Try one conversation and observe the consequence of an action before designing a perfect route. Let curiosity about the characters decide whether another run sounds worthwhile.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally admitted for readers who enjoy a devious school mystery; my reference letter has been returned for an independent author and a smaller font.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2963890/>

P226 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: mixed / native co-op: unknown

Machinarium

The Robot Has Repaired Everything Except My Reputation

Edition considered: PC release

I offered Josef a management position in our office on the basis that he appeared able to survive being thrown away and still solve practical problems. Tank said this qualified him to replace most of the furniture as well as me.

Machinarium's rusty city communicated through gestures, pictures and mechanical predicaments. I tried to introduce a spoken keynote. Mercedes pointed out that the robots had been doing perfectly well before I arrived with paragraphs.

Shawna examined the puzzle. Rosa noticed what the little character seemed to need. I opened a diagram so complicated that it could have powered a separate industrial district if connected to steam.

The answer required paying attention to the actual scene, a skill I am delighted to endorse whenever somebody else has already demonstrated it. We let one person operate and shared ideas by invitation. Josef continued his adventure. I offered him a ceremonial promotion to Director of Getting On With It, but Tank said the title would only slow him down.

The actual attraction

Guide a small robot through a hand-drawn mechanical city, solving logical puzzles and helping people he cares about. Animated thought bubbles replace long spoken conversations, giving a companion plenty to observe without requiring two playable characters.

The catch worth knowing

Inventory logic, small targets, brain teasers and minigames can become demanding. Wordless presentation does not mean obvious solutions or zero timing. Check the chosen PC interface and any puzzle assistance directly; the inspected source does not certify a fully untimed completion path.

An opening invitation

Explore the opening scene and try one object interaction. Ask whether the drawings and character gestures are appealing even before solving anything. Share a single suggestion only when requested, allowing the player to keep the satisfying discovery.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional shared-observation choice when a rusty robot seems like excellent company; my honorary promotion remains unsigned to protect his productivity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/40700/>

P227 / PROMISING / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Botanicula

The Seed Has Declined to Become a Strategic Asset

Edition considered: PC release

I gathered five tiny office objects to represent Botanicula's unlikely friends. There was a button, a leaf, a cork, a bent paperclip and the miniature red stapler, which immediately demanded a better view.

Their mission was to save a seed. I suggested a preservation strategy involving branding rights and a five-year growth forecast. Rosa put the seed in a safe dish while I was still calculating the forecast. The practical work had once again been completed behind my presentation.

The little creatures' strange abilities and comic reactions made the world feel alive. Mercedes wanted to click on something simply to see what it would do. Shawna said that was a perfectly good reason, provided we did not confuse delightful reactions with a promise that every puzzle would be effortless.

Tank named the cork Acting Director of Silence. Its performance was exemplary. I accepted a smaller role as observer and found an entire forest of peculiar business that had no interest in my organisational chart.

The actual attraction

Five tree creatures travel to protect the last seed of their home from parasites. The attraction is discovery: peculiar inhabitants, playful animations and inventive sound turn looking and clicking into a sequence of small surprises.

The catch worth knowing

Minimal text shifts the work toward interpreting visual behaviour, finding hotspots and inferring unusual puzzle rules. Some tasks may need precision or repeated attempts; the publisher's broad relaxed-play language is not a whole-game input audit. Shared observation remains distinct from native cooperative control.

An opening invitation

Explore a small area and interact with several visible creatures without trying to clear everything. Check the pointing demands and whether the nonverbal clues feel inviting. A companion can enjoy the reactions without supplying a running solution commentary.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising for someone drawn to curious little creatures and experimental clicking; the seed has no growth targets, and the cork retains its leadership position.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/207690/>

P228 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Samorost 3

My Cosmic Flute Has Become a Parking Violation

Edition considered: PC release

I announced an interplanetary expedition with a flute, a helmet and a certificate proving I was allowed to announce interplanetary expeditions. Tank asked which item would get us out of the kitchen.

Samorost 3 sent a curious gnome into stranger and lovelier places than my equipment inspection had prepared for. Sound, creatures and unusual objects suggested a world to discover rather than a list of achievements to recite.

I blew across the top of a bottle to demonstrate musical insight. Mercedes moved the bottle away from the microphone. Shawna watched the actual game for a pattern instead of treating my improvised noise as a clue.

Rosa said we could linger over one scene if that was where the pleasure was. This offended the timetable I had printed but suited everyone present. We followed a small discovery to another. My certificate was eventually folded beneath a wobbly table leg, giving the expedition its first demonstrably stable piece of equipment.

The actual attraction

A space gnome follows the mystery of a magical flute through alien worlds full of creatures, images and music. The pleasure can lie in interpreting an unfamiliar place together, with one person operating the adventure and another noticing details.

The catch worth knowing

Sound and visual patterns matter to the experience, and some puzzle logic is deliberately strange. Check any audio-dependent clue, hotspot size and object manipulation directly. The inspected description supports exploration and puzzles, not a guarantee of no timers, no dragging or easy completion.

An opening invitation

Visit the opening area, listen at a comfortable volume and try a few visible interactions. Decide whether uncertainty feels intriguing or obstructive. Invite a companion to describe one noticed detail without immediately searching for an external solution.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally recommended for a visitor who wants the cosmos to remain peculiar; my expedition certificate has been downgraded to structural support.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/421120/>

P229 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

LEGO City Undercover

My Undercover Identity Is Clearly Printed on My Badge

Edition considered: 2017 PC release; not original Wii U edition

I went undercover as a perfectly ordinary citizen wearing a badge that read AIDEN, SECRETLY IMPORTANT. Tank advised that the first word undermined anonymity and the other two undermined everything else.

LEGO City Undercover offered disguises, vehicles and a city full of comic business. I was immediately attracted to the possibility of changing jobs whenever the current one exposed a weakness in my qualifications.

Shawna kept our edition straight: the 2017 PC release includes two-player cooperation, unlike an assumption imported casually from another version. Mercedes examined the city rather than my costume and asked whether both people actually enjoyed steering through it.

Rosa wanted a manageable little outing, not a compulsory campaign against every collectible. We agreed on one short objective. I retired the badge and chose a less conspicuous jacket. Tank said this was progress until I asked whether the jacket could carry an embroidered explanation of how inconspicuous I had become.

The actual attraction

Chase McCain pursues a criminal through a large LEGO city, using disguises, vehicles and comic situations. The 2017 PC release explicitly supports two-player cooperation, so companions can participate in the city rather than only watch its story.

The catch worth knowing

Open-world navigation, camera control, driving, fights, jumping and collecting create a broad action workload. A familiar toy aesthetic does not simplify every task. Check split-screen legibility and each controller setup before assuming the shared view works comfortably.

An opening invitation

Try walking, looking around and one simple objective together before driving fast or chasing collectibles. Agree on a meeting place and whether exploration or story is the purpose. Stop when the city's activity becomes more busy than amusing.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional urban action choice for two people who enjoy roaming and slapstick; undercover badges must stop announcing that their owner is secretly important.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/578330/>

P230 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

LEGO Star Wars: The Skywalker Saga

The Galaxy Has Too Many Menus for My Cape

Edition considered: PC base game

I selected a cape for our galactic expedition and immediately caught it in a chair. Tank said this was a practical argument for droids. I said the incident would not appear in the official saga.

The Skywalker Saga offered an enormous collection of familiar places, characters and conflicts. I proposed seeing everything tonight. Shawna looked at the scale of that promise and asked whether I had confused an evening with a geological period.

Mercedes picked one character she actually liked. Rosa picked a comfortable seat. These modest decisions got us closer to playing than my proposed Comprehensive Galactic Appreciation Programme.

We tried a little movement and a little cooperation. The galaxy still included fighting, aiming, vehicles and more than one thing to remember. I kept the cape off the controller and resisted explaining every reference. Tank remarked that this was the first time he had seen me bring balance to anything without borrowing a spirit level. I accepted the compliment before he could clarify its limits.

The actual attraction

The nine Skywalker films become a large comic action adventure with local cooperative play. Familiar scenes, many characters and places to explore can make a lively shared journey for people who already enjoy the setting.

The catch worth knowing

Combat includes aiming and attack combinations, and the game adds vehicles, camera movement, character abilities and extensive menus. The large scope can overwhelm a simple evening plan. Split-screen comfort and both players' controls need checking; brand familiarity does not remove those demands.

An opening invitation

Choose one starting trilogy and test a small opening section together. Try looking, moving, attacking and selecting a character without pursuing every collectible. Decide whether the shared jokes justify the action load before treating the whole saga as a commitment.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional galaxy-sized outing for willing action partners; the Comprehensive Galactic Appreciation Programme has been reduced to one scene and a cape safely on its hanger.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/920210/>

P231 / PROMISING / mixed input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

LEGO Builder's Journey

The Monument Is Six Bricks High and Already Over Budget

Edition considered: PC release; Creative mode separate

I began LEGO Builder's Journey by proposing a structure visible from space. Mercedes placed six little bricks on the table and asked whether I could first make something visible from my chair.

The game's miniature arrangements gave each piece a consequence. A small bridge could matter more than my entire monument proposal. Tank rearranged two bricks and solved the physical problem I had been trying to address with a commemorative plaque.

Shawna noticed that the PC release also had a separate Creative Mode. Rosa liked the idea of making a little scene without treating it as an exam. I suggested a tasteful statue of the committee's founder. Nobody asked whom I meant, which was at once gratifying and unhelpful.

We built something smaller: a place to cross and a place to stand. The result did not celebrate me, but it did have an entrance, unlike several of my earlier designs. I granted it provisional architectural approval. Mercedes turned the approval sheet into a backdrop and improved the scene again.

The actual attraction

Small geometric LEGO puzzles tell an atmospheric story through placed pieces and changing situations. The PC release separately includes Creative Mode for free construction and photographs, offering another route when arranging objects is more appealing than solving the narrative.

The catch worth knowing

Selecting, rotating, positioning and viewing small pieces may require precision. A quiet presentation does not prove every placement avoids holds or dragging. This is single-player; discussing designs beside someone is optional shared activity, not verified native cooperative control.

An opening invitation

Try one simple placement and rotate the view before choosing a longer puzzle. Alternatively, inspect Creative Mode and make a tiny scene. Let the person's interest in solving or building determine the mode instead of insisting on story progress.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising for somebody who enjoys a small meaningful arrangement; my monument is postponed until six bricks can survive an independent review.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1544360/>

P232 / PROMISING / directional input / pace: waits / native co-op: no

The Gardens Between

I Have Rewound the Meeting but the Minutes Still Embarrass Me

Edition considered: PC release

I wanted a way to revisit a meeting and improve the moment when I called the printer a sentient strategic partner. The Gardens Between offered time manipulation, although unfortunately only inside its own carefully designed world.

Arina and Frendt moved among oversized objects from their shared past. I proposed assigning every office object a dramatic memory. Tank picked the broken stapler and recalled the day I bought a replacement that was too small to staple anything.

The puzzles invited us to think about sequence: what changes when time moves one way, and what becomes possible when it moves back? Shawna watched the relationships between objects while Mercedes noticed the feeling of the scene.

Rosa said the friendship mattered more than whether we solved everything quickly. The developer's explicit absence of time pressure supported that approach. I rewound my imaginary meeting again and tried saying less. Everyone agreed this was a promising revision, although the printer's alleged strategic status would remain in the archive forever.

The actual attraction

Manipulate time through dreamlike island scenes built from two friends' memories. The publisher explicitly describes a single-player game with no text, speech or time pressure, giving shared observation room to focus on images and sequences.

The catch worth knowing

You control the flow of time rather than simply steering each friend independently.

Understanding cause and sequence can still be demanding, and sustained input to move time needs a direct check. Simple controls do not automatically mean no holds. This is shared thinking beside one player, not native co-op.

An opening invitation

Move time forward and back in the opening scene, noticing one object that changes or interacts differently. Check how the input feels before pursuing a long sequence. Decide whether the visual friendship story gives the puzzle enough emotional interest.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising when watching a small memory become a mechanism sounds appealing; my printer's executive title cannot be removed through ordinary calendar adjustment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher description explicitly calls The Gardens Between single-player and states no text, speech, time pressure or complex UI. Time manipulation, friendship and island puzzles are supported. The card retains uncertainty about sustained input and does not equate simple controls with no holds.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/600990/>

P233 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Day of the Tentacle Remastered

The Tentacle Has a Better Succession Plan Than I Do

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

A purple tentacle announced an ambition to take over the world, and I was forced to admit that the competition for ridiculous authority had become serious. Mine had so far reached only the cupboard above the kettle.

Day of the Tentacle put three friends in different times. I immediately saw a chance to send my unfinished paperwork into the past. Shawna asked whether I understood that this might simply make it overdue for longer.

Tank wanted to know what an object could do in another era. Mercedes noticed a visual joke. Rosa asked whether we could follow one thread without opening every inventory at once. These were all better questions than my proposal to appoint a Deputy Director of Yesterday.

We tried to understand one cause and its distant effect. A funny solution became visible when we stopped insisting that objects obey ordinary office logic. I sent no paperwork through time. The tentacle's world-conquest application remained under review, primarily because it had arrived without the correct stationery.

The actual attraction

A cartoon adventure links three protagonists across time, turning changes in one era into possibilities in another. The Remastered edition offers revised art and audio alongside classic presentation options, with comedy built into the puzzle logic.

The catch worth knowing

Inventories, character switching and consequences across different periods create a real memory burden. Cartoon logic may feel inventive or arbitrary. The source does not establish every timing or hold demand; preview the interface and selected presentation rather than assuming a classic adventure is automatically easy.

An opening invitation

Explore an early room and identify one useful object or conversation. Try switching the presentation if you prefer, then decide whether the humour and inventory handling appeal. A companion can keep one current question visible without delivering the whole solution.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally approved for people amused by consequences arriving centuries late; my overdue paperwork is forbidden from using the time machine.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/388210/>

P234 / DETOUR / mixed input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Trine Enchanted Edition

The Wizard Has Built a Box Around My Management Style

Edition considered: PC Enchanted Edition

I chose the wizard because creating objects from thin air seemed close to my usual budgeting method. Tank chose the knight. Mercedes asked whether anybody had remembered the actual puzzle before selecting a profession.

Trine bound different abilities into one adventure. I summoned an imaginary box and announced that leadership had provided the necessary infrastructure. Shawna pointed out that I had placed it directly in everyone's way.

The thief could approach a space differently; the knight could handle dangers my splendid box did nothing to discourage. Rosa suggested that roles should follow what people enjoyed doing, rather than whichever title best matched my jacket.

We moved the box. This produced a route, a useful metaphor and the first genuine improvement my magic department had delivered all morning. I offered a speech about complementary strengths. Tank lifted the box again and looked meaningfully at me. I understood that cooperation sometimes meant leaving enough room for the other characters, both on the path and in the conversation.

The actual attraction

Wizard, knight and thief combine different abilities in a fantasy world of physical puzzles and combat. Enchanted Edition supports up to three players locally or online, and the original 2009 release is also included as a separate launcher choice.

The catch worth knowing

Platforming, fighting, aiming and grappling remain active demands, with different burdens by character. The inspected description declares saving options and the store lists adjustable difficulty, but neither establishes a no-reflex or no-hold path. Choose Enchanted Edition deliberately rather than mixing its features with the original.

An opening invitation

In an early section, try each preferred character's movement and one ability. Discuss whether roles feel satisfying before combining them under pressure. A companion should not become the compulsory combat department unless that is genuinely the role they want.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A deliberate fantasy-action detour for a group that enjoys physical puzzles; boxes bearing my departmental logo must demonstrate that they are not blocking the exit.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/35700/>

P235 / PROMISING / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Pilgrims

The Traveller Has Declined My One Correct Solution

Edition considered: PC digital game; not the board game

I approached Pilgrims with an official sequence of events. First, meet a traveller. Second, assign the traveller a purpose. Third, demand a progress report before the traveller had finished sitting down.

The game preferred play. An object or character might produce an unexpected response, and different solutions could be part of the pleasure. Mercedes tried something simply because it looked funny. My schedule shuddered but remained technically printable.

Tank offered a new rule: if an experiment made us laugh, we were allowed to count it as something that happened. Shawna pointed out that this was not even a rule, merely an accurate description of enjoying a game.

Rosa gave the imaginary traveller a place at the table without requiring a completed objective. I revised my sequence to begin with See What Happens. This was so alarmingly short that I nearly added an appendix. The tiny red stapler, placed on the blank paper, restrained me more effectively than several previous policy committees.

The actual attraction

A playful illustrated adventure encourages trying items and characters in different situations, with multiple solutions rather than one fixed route through every task. Its brief, expressive reactions can be enjoyable to discover with someone watching beside you.

The catch worth knowing

Interpreting unusual responses and managing available objects still requires attention. Test how cards or items are selected and moved; do not assume that a playful interface avoids dragging or held actions. The inspected publisher description presents single-player experimentation, not verified native cooperative control.

An opening invitation

Try a couple of early combinations and watch what happens without demanding immediate progress. Check whether manipulating the items feels comfortable. A companion can suggest an experiment, but the person playing gets to choose which curiosity to follow.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Promising for people who like a story that tolerates a little messing about; the committee has authorised See What Happens and denied its appendix.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1049280/>

P236 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

The Longest Journey

Two Universes Have Both Misplaced My Reservation

Edition considered: Original PC release

I booked an imaginary journey between parallel worlds and requested a suite in each. The first world had no record of me. The second had apparently heard about the first and decided to maintain the policy.

April Ryan's adventure offered a much better reason to travel: people, puzzles and the uneasy relationship between different realities. I began drawing a map that reserved the centre for my portrait. Shawna moved the portrait to the margin so the worlds could actually fit.

Tank asked which conversation we wanted to follow next. Mercedes wanted time with the atmosphere. Rosa said a long story could be visited in pieces rather than swallowed as a demonstration of commitment.

I put the map down and listened. The older presentation asked for a little patience, but patience was not the same as an obligation to tolerate an uncomfortable interface. We agreed to check that first. My suite remained unavailable in both universes, which I described as remarkably consistent cross-dimensional customer service.

The actual attraction

April Ryan moves between parallel universes in a substantial original PC adventure filled with conversations, places and puzzles. Its appeal is spending time with a large imaginative world; another person can share the story and discuss clues beside the player.

The catch worth knowing

This older PC release needs a compatibility and readability check on the actual machine. Long dialogue, inventory puzzles, repeated travel and remembering multiple locations add work. Do not infer no timers, no holds or modern interface options from its age or genre.

An opening invitation

Launch the exact original release, inspect text and save behavior, then hear an opening conversation and try an object interaction. Decide whether the people and world justify the interface effort before treating the title as a promise to finish a very long journey.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally approved for readers who want to inhabit an expansive older adventure; neither universe is required to provide my requested executive suite.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/6310/>

P237 / CONDITIONAL / pointer input / pace: unknown / native co-op: unknown

Broken Age

The Talking Spoon Has Requested a Different Destiny

Edition considered: PC complete two-act release

A talking spoon seemed a natural addition to my office, where several silent objects already carried more responsibility than their job descriptions allowed. I appointed it Deputy Minister of Breakfast before asking whether it wanted the position.

Broken Age's two young protagonists had their own reasons to question the lives arranged for them. Mercedes looked at the spoon's appointment letter and asked whether I had understood that part of the premise.

Shawna suggested we follow one character's situation first. Tank wanted to test an object interaction rather than sit through my address on destiny. Rosa asked the spoon what it would like for breakfast, which was an odd question but at least granted it some agency.

We switched perspectives and found a world stranger than my office, although considerably better painted. I withdrew the appointment letter. The spoon remained on the table by choice, or at least without written evidence to the contrary. My own destiny involved washing it after lunch, a role with unusually clear responsibilities.

The actual attraction

Vella and Shay navigate very different worlds while trying to take control of their lives. The complete two-act point-and-click adventure combines hand-drawn scenes, voice performances, odd characters and puzzles, with switching between the protagonists part of the structure.

The catch worth knowing

Two story threads and inventory reasoning can require remembering details across scenes. Later puzzle complexity should not be inferred from an approachable opening. The developer page supports the premise and point-and-click form, not a full no-timer or no-hold certification. This is shared viewing of a single-player adventure.

An opening invitation

Hear an opening conversation, try one interaction and look at the character-switching interface. Choose which story to follow by interest. A companion can remember an earlier clue without taking over every decision or explaining a solution before it is wanted.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally welcome for someone who likes imaginative characters questioning their assigned roles; the spoon's ministerial appointment has been rescinded with full washing privileges.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.doublefine.com/games/broken-age>

P238 / **CONDITIONAL** / camera input / pace: real time / native co-op: yes

Dinkum

The Crocodile Has Rejected My Welcome Pack

Edition considered: PC release; current version status must be checked

I arrived in Dinkum with a town charter, a decorative shovel and a welcome pack for the local wildlife. Tank asked whether the wildlife had agreed to a town. I said consultation would follow the ribbon cutting.

The game combined building a settlement with a landscape that could be beautiful and dangerous. I attempted to admire a creature on behalf of the tourism department. Shawna suggested admiring it from somewhere less likely to become lunch.

Mercedes wanted to design a pleasant place to live. Rosa wanted the daily tasks to stay manageable. Both intentions seemed more useful than my plan to name every building before we had gathered its materials.

We started small and kept an eye on what survival actually required. I put the wildlife welcome packs back in the binder. The crocodile, as far as our imaginary correspondence established, preferred a more direct approach to visitors. Tank proposed making this fact the town's first piece of useful public information.

The actual attraction

Explore, gather, farm and build a settlement in an Australian-inspired landscape, meeting residents and inviting friends online. The full PC release combines town creation with survival and also includes a separate Creative Mode, offering a different focus for building.

The catch worth knowing

Default play includes wild animals, tools, combat, gathering, crafting and a three-dimensional view. Creative Mode changes building options, not the need to check camera comfort. Official launch notes leave some town quests to the host. Record the installed version rather than relying on old Early Access advice.

An opening invitation

Try walking, looking around and one modest town task before entering dangerous terrain. Inspect Creative Mode if building is the attraction, then check the chosen multiplayer permissions. Ask whether both players enjoy their available tasks rather than assigning one all the work.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional settlement project when both building and some danger appeal; wildlife welcome packs must be delivered by neither me nor anybody else.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched PC Steam description supports Australian-inspired survival, farming and online cooperation. Official launch announcements explicitly confirm the April 23, 2025 UTC exit from Early Access, Creative Mode and revised multiplayer permissions. Some town/building quests remain host-only in those launch notes. Current build behavior still needs checking; observed September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1062520/>

Source 2: https://store.steampowered.com/news/posts/?appid=1062520&enddate=1745490680&feed=steam_community_announcements

P239 / **CONDITIONAL** / camera input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Farm Together

The Carrots Have Continued Growing Without My Supervision

Edition considered: PC first game

I left Farm Together for a moment and returned to the shocking possibility that the farm had continued existing without my strategic attention. I had not approved this independence. The carrots appeared entirely unmoved.

Time advancing while we were away could mean a pleasant return to something ready for attention. I tried to convert it into a compulsory check-in schedule. Rosa removed the schedule and said crops in a game were not entitled to summon us from dinner.

Tank liked the possibility of doing a little work side by side. Mercedes wanted a farm with paths that led somewhere attractive, rather than directly to my proposed founder's pavilion. Shawna checked the visiting permissions before imagining a shared project.

We planned a modest patch and an equally modest return. The tractor was allowed to remain a tool rather than a symbol of my agricultural authority. I still asked the carrots for a report. Their continued silence was both insubordinate and, according to everyone else, an excellent influence on the office.

The actual attraction

Grow crops, keep animals, decorate a farm and invite other players to cultivate it together. The first Farm Together explicitly lets time progress while you are offline, creating a place that can be revisited rather than requiring continuous attendance.

The catch worth knowing

Repeated tending, expansion, currencies, waiting and item menus can become a workload. Movement and camera handling need a direct check. Online farm permissions matter when sharing; the source does not establish every activity as untimed or hold-free. This card covers the first game, not its sequel.

An opening invitation

Plant or tend one small area and inspect how a friend joins and what they may change. Try camera movement and a basic interaction. Decide whether returning to growing things feels pleasant without agreeing to an attendance schedule.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

Conditionally welcome for companions who like a persistent shared garden; the carrots' refusal to attend my progress meeting is fully protected.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 673950 is the first Farm Together, published by Milkstone Studios. Product description explicitly supports shared farming, permissions and time advancing offline. These claims are not imported from Farm Together 2; exact control comfort remains untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/673950/>

P240 / CONDITIONAL / camera input / pace: mixed / native co-op: yes

Staxel

The Village Has Built a House Where My Master Plan Used to Be

Edition considered: PC release

For the final farm proposal, I promised to listen before producing a master plan. This was easy for almost twelve seconds. Then I saw a flat patch of ground and began mentally arranging a ceremonial avenue.

Staxel let us shape a blocky village, restore a farm and work alongside friends. Tank wanted a useful workshop. Rosa wanted somewhere welcoming. Mercedes wanted to choose the colours herself, a terrifying but constitutionally sound development.

Shawna tested the movement and building controls before granting my imaginary planning permission. A first-person world required looking and moving, even if the activity was domestic. We agreed that a pleasant project could still be the wrong fit for a particular evening.

I set down the plan. Somebody put up a wall; somebody else noticed where a window should go. The little house became a record of choices made together rather than evidence that I had arrived first. I offered to carry the furniture. For once, nobody needed to revise my job description.

The actual attraction

Restore a farm, meet villagers and alter a voxel world through building and cultivation. The PC game explicitly supports online cooperation, allowing friends to share a farm or become neighbours while making their own projects.

The catch worth knowing

First-person movement, camera steering, selecting materials, crafting and placing blocks can create substantial coordination and menu demands. Farming tasks add routine work. The publisher's creative premise does not certify no holds, no timed activities or a frictionless multiplayer setup.

An opening invitation

Try looking around, moving through a doorway and placing or interacting with a simple object. If sharing online, establish who owns the session and how both people join. Choose one small project only after the controls feel worth using.

Aiden's entirely unnecessary ruling

A conditional final invitation for people who enjoy making a place together; my master plan has become spare paper, and the house is better for it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 405710 is Staxel, with explicit online co-op and shared-farm or neighbour play in the publisher description. Voxel building, village life and crops are supported. Camera workload and first trial are editorial checks, not access certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/405710/>

The Commission Votes to Leave the Door Open

The final vote concerned what the commission should do next. I had prepared three options: expand, establish a regional office, or expand while establishing a regional office. Mercedes wrote **PLAY SOMETHING** in the margin. It won unanimously.

“I haven't voted,” I said.

“You announced the vote was unanimous before you printed the ballot,” Shawna said.

The evidence was in my handwriting. We accepted the result.

Forty entries had given us several different kinds of company. Two characters sharing a world. Two people describing separate clues. A friend watching an absurd scene. A quiet debate over a railway route. A building project that could become a pleasant afternoon or a second job. The useful question remained the one we had started with: what would each person actually do, and would they enjoy doing it?

That question also permitted no. A game could be beautiful and still ask for movement somebody did not want. A cooperative mode could be generous and still give one person a role they found dull. A friend could be dear and still offer far too many instructions. In the last case, I recommended sandwiches as an interim measure and listening as the longer-term repair.

Tank put the second controller beside the first. He did not hand it to anybody. That small decision made the invitation feel different. There it was if wanted. Nothing in the room demanded an answer.

Rosa cleared the plate. She found the stamped slice of bread under my notes.

“Are we preserving this?”

“Founding document.”

“Compost.”

We had a brief constitutional discussion, which the bread lost.

I lifted the enormous binder from the table. Everybody watched, perhaps expecting the building to sigh with relief. It was heavier than any ordinary answer to what to play should have been. That was part of the joke. The real route through it could still be tiny: choose one interesting game, read the catch, try one meaningful thing, and decide whether to continue. The rest was optional company.

Shawna took half the weight. Tank opened the cabinet. Mercedes moved the shelf that I had installed upside down several volumes earlier. Rosa insisted that the snacks remain outside the filing system. Together we found a place for the book that did not require anyone to hold it indefinitely.

The gold stamp went in a drawer. The tiny red stapler stayed on the table. I left the ASK card beside it, where I would see it before developing another policy.

“So what are you now?” Mercedes asked.

I considered Director Emeritus of Recreational Companionship. It had a nice shape. It could fit on a brass plate. It could also turn a quiet evening into another delivery appointment.

“Available,” I said.

Tank nodded. “Good. Bring the water.”

I brought the water. No one applauded. Nobody needed to. The game was already interesting, the chairs were comfortable, and for once the administration had improved the evening by getting out of its way.

An index with no authority over you

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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. Original Panorama prose, system design, research compilation and production: ChatGPT. A new companion experiment using the user-directed Ten Toes Down characters; the existing novels remain intact. Dedicated to Lillian and to the pleasure of finding something worth another turn.

Voice sources sampled: the revised Ten Toes Down six-book edition, especially Book I's funeral opening and Book II's academy arrival, plus the repository editorial record. Repository snapshot: 4f38948aa5fa97f294adfa74a0b7055c399b2826. The complete novels were not reread line by line for this project.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and <https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.